



△ **Breguet-Dorand
Gyroplane 1936**

Origin France

Engine 240 hp Hispano-Suiza radial

Top speed 62 mph (100 km/h)

This worthy claimant to the title of "first successful helicopter," flew at 70 mph (113 km/h) and stayed airborne for an hour in 1936. It was destroyed by the Allied bombing of Villacoublay airfield, France in 1943.

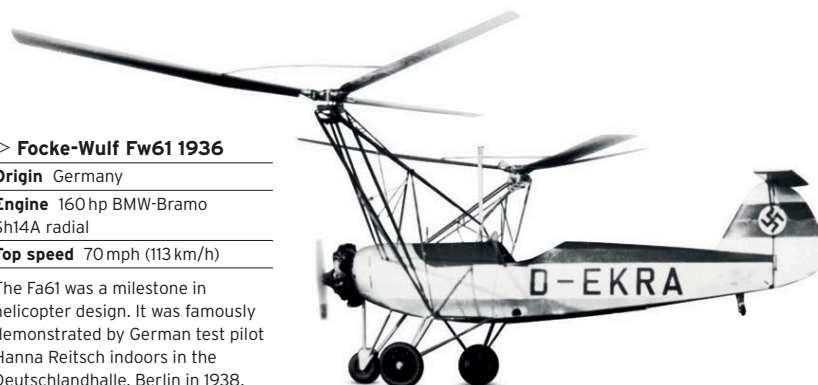
▷ **Focke-Wulf Fw61 1936**

Origin Germany

Engine 160 hp BMW-Bramo Sh14A radial

Top speed 70 mph (113 km/h)

The Fw61 was a milestone in helicopter design. It was famously demonstrated by German test pilot Hanna Reitsch indoors in the Deutschlandhalle, Berlin in 1938.



▽ **SNCASE Liore et Olivier
LeO C302 1939**

Origin France

Engine 175 hp Salmson 9Ne radial

Top speed 112 mph (180 km/h)

LeO, in 1937 nationalized as SNCASE—also known as Sud Est—held Cierva's rotor patent for France and created a machine with improved jump-takeoff ability and better landing characteristics.



△ **Sikorsky VS-300 1939**

Origin USA

Engine 75 hp Lycoming

Top speed 64 mph (103 km/h)

Igor Sikorsky's single, powered rotor with antitorque tail rotor—known by the company as "Igor's Nightmare"—established the template for the successful helicopter, which made the autogyro obsolete.

